

ShadowTalk • User Manual

Local-first AI desktop chat application

Version v1.4.1

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1. Introduction

ShadowTalk is a local-first AI desktop chat application. You can create multiple AI friends (each with their own persona, memory, and voice) and chat with them in immersive scenes.

Core Features

- **Local-first**: All messages, memories, and settings are stored locally in a SQLite database on your machine. Nothing is uploaded to any server.
- **Long-term memory**: The AI automatically compresses early conversations into hierarchical summaries, remembering your chat history across sessions.
- **Immersive scenes**: Themed environments like cafes, with background images and scene prompts for a more atmospheric conversation.

- **Voice playback**: AI replies can be automatically read aloud (based on Edge TTS).
- **AI tool sandbox**: The AI can execute Python code in an isolated environment to help you process files and generate documents.
- **Email sync**: Digital twins can communicate with you asynchronously via email, with replies automatically appearing in chat.

2. Installation & Launch

Windows Portable Version

1. Download `ShadowTalk.exe`.
2. Double-click to run — no installation required.
3. On first launch, the database and configuration are created automatically.

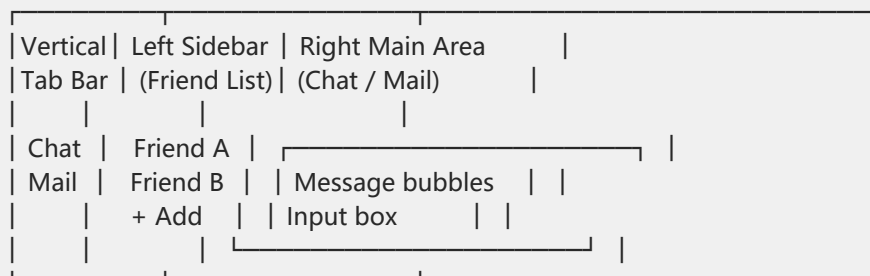
The data directory is located in the same folder as the exe (portable design, travels with your USB drive).

Developer Version (from source)

```
python -m venv venv
venv\Scripts\pip install -r requirements.txt
venv\Scripts\python shadowtalk\main.py
```

3. Interface Overview

The main window uses a three-column layout:



- **Vertical Tab Bar** (leftmost): Switch between "Chat" and "Mail" modes.
- **Left Sidebar**: Friend list (shown in Chat mode), with an add button at the top.
- **Right Main Area**: Shows the conversation in Chat mode; shows the mail list in Mail mode.

The top menu bar has "Settings" and "Help" menus. The bottom status bar shows the current status and an AI output disclaimer.

4. Adding Friends

1. Click the **" + Add Friend"** button at the bottom of the friend list.
2. Fill in the dialog:

Field	Description
Name	AI friend's name
Remark	Display name in the list (overrides name)
Avatar	Choose from local images
AI Role	Role the AI plays (e.g., "Barista", "Secretary")
User Role	Role you play (e.g., "Regular", "Boss")
Work Directory	Directory where the AI sandbox can read/write files
Voice	TTS voice (default: Xiaoxiao)
System Prompt	Defines the AI's personality, tone, and behavior rules

3. Click "OK" to save.

****Tip**:** The more specific the system prompt, the better the AI's behavior matches your expectations.

5. Chatting

Sending Messages

1. Click a friend in the left list.
2. Type a message in the input box at the bottom right, press ****Enter**** to send.
3. The AI will reply after thinking, shown as message bubbles.

Voice Playback

- AI replies are automatically read aloud (can be disabled in Settings).
- Click the voice button on a message bubble to replay.

Interruption & Retry

- If you send a new message while the AI is still replying, the old task is automatically interrupted.
- Network errors show "Reply failed" — simply retry.

AI Tool Sandbox

When the AI needs to execute code (e.g., processing files, generating charts), a **write approval card** appears:

- Code written within the friend's "work directory" is automatically approved.
- Writing outside the directory requires your confirmation. Click "Allow" or "Deny".

6. Immersive Chat Rooms

Click the scene button at the top of the main interface, select a friend, and enter the **Cafe** scene.

- Scenes have independent background images and atmosphere prompts.
- Chat within a scene shares the same message history as regular chat with that friend.
- After closing the scene window, the main interface automatically refreshes to show the latest messages.

7. Email Sync (Digital Twins)

Digital twins can communicate with you asynchronously via email, ideal for slow-paced, deep exchanges.

Configuring Email

Open "Settings > Mail Configuration" and fill in:

Field	Description
SMTP Server	Outgoing server (e.g., smtp.qq.com)
SMTP Port	Outgoing port (default: 587)
SMTP Username	Sender email
SMTP Password	Email authorization code (not login password)
IMAP Server	Incoming server (e.g., imap.qq.com)
IMAP Username	Recipient email
IMAP Password	Email authorization code

Sync Mechanism

- The app periodically checks due friends and packages new conversations into emails sent to the asset authorizer.
- When the authorizer replies, the app automatically fetches and inserts the reply into the corresponding friend's chat.
- Replies appear as "human" role bubbles in chat.

Sync Cycle

Set when adding/editing friends: Daily / Weekly / Monthly.

8. Importing Digital Twin Assets

The app supports importing shared "digital twins":

1. Click the **"Import Twin"** button at the bottom of the friend list.
2. Paste the asset ciphertext.
3. Preview the decrypted twin information.
4. Confirm to import, automatically creating the corresponding friend.

Assets are encrypted with AES-128-CTR + HMAC-SHA256; only parties holding the correct key can encrypt/decrypt.

Authorization Revocation

If the twin's creator revokes authorization, that twin's chat is frozen (cannot continue sending), but message history is preserved.

9. Settings

Open via the top menu "Settings > API & Memory".

API Configuration

Field	Description	Default
API Address	OpenAI-compatible endpoint	https://api.longcat.chat/openai/v1
API Key	API key	(enter your own)
Model Name	Model to use	LongCat-2.0
Temperature	Output randomness (0-2)	0.7
Max Output Length	Max tokens per reply	20000
Tool Call Limit	Max tool calls per turn	15
Tool Execution Timeout	Timeout per tool execution (seconds)	120

Multiple API configurations can be added in the "API Configuration" tab (add/delete/switch). The toolbar dropdown allows quick switching of the active model.

Memory Parameters

Field	Description
Raw Message Keep	Recent rounds to keep uncompressed
Batch Size	Rounds per batch before summary compression
Summary Valid (days)	Batch summaries expire and merge into high-level summaries
Summary Target Chars	Target length for L1 summaries
Max Context Tokens	Max context sent to the AI per request
L2 Limit	Max high-level summaries to retain

Mail Configuration

See [7. Email Sync](#7-email-sync-digital-twins).

10. Data & Privacy

Data Storage

Data Type	Location
Database	Data directory / shadowtalk.db
Avatars	Data directory / avatars/
Prompt Logs	Data directory / prompt_logs/
Mail Attachments	Data directory / mail_attachments/

Privacy Principles

- ****Local-first****: All data is stored locally; the app does not connect to any telemetry/statistics

servers.

- ****AI Calls****: Messages are sent to the configured AI endpoint, handled by that service provider.
- ****Portable****: The Windows portable version stores all data next to the exe; deleting it erases everything.

Backup & Migration

- Copy the entire data directory to back up.
 - Move the data directory to the same relative location on another computer to restore.
-

11. FAQ

Q: Missing DLL error on first launch?

A: Install Visual C++ Redistributable 2015-2022 (x64).

Q: AI replies "Initialization failed"?

A: Check that the API address, key, and model name are correct; check network connectivity.

Q: AI suddenly stops talking (empty bubble)?

A: The model may have returned empty content. Try resending, or switch to a different model.

Q: Not receiving email replies?

A: Check that the IMAP configuration is correct; confirm IMAP is enabled on the email service; check that the authorization code is valid.

Q: How to switch between dark/light theme?

A: Click the theme toggle button in the toolbar.

Q: How to completely delete all data?

A: Close the app and delete the data directory. This operation cannot be undone — back up first.

12. Shortcuts & Tips

Action	Description
Enter	Send message
Shift + Enter	New line in input box
Click avatar	View/edit friend info

Tips

- ****Persona writing****: Clearly define the AI's personality, catchphrases, and behavioral boundaries in the system prompt for more stable results.
 - ****Work directory****: Assign independent work directories to each friend to avoid interference when the AI executes code.
 - ****Memory tuning****: If the AI can't remember things, increase "Raw Message Keep" or "Max Context Tokens".
 - ****Tool sandbox****: When using code execution for the first time, pay attention to the approval card prompts and confirm safety before allowing.
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AI output is for reference only. Please verify before relying on it.

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ShadowTalk · Let AI friends live on your computer.